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VNR VIGNANA JYOTHI INSTITUTE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY

(AUTONOMOUS)

III B.Tech. I Semester 2nd Mid-Sessional Examinations, December 2022

PROFESSIONAL ETHICS AND HUMAN VALUES

(Common To All Branches)

Time: 90 Minutes **Date of Examination: 23.Dec.2022** **Max. Marks: 30 Marks**

PART-A

I. Answer all the following in not more than four lines: **3 × 2 Marks = 6 Marks**

1.	What is collegiality?	CO-4	BL-1
2.	List any four computer ethics.	CO-3	BL-1
3.	Do you think teaching Ethics as a theory course helps people grow practically better? If yes, please write down the definition of something that impacted you the most through this course. If not, justify very briefly.	CO-1	BL-5

PART-B

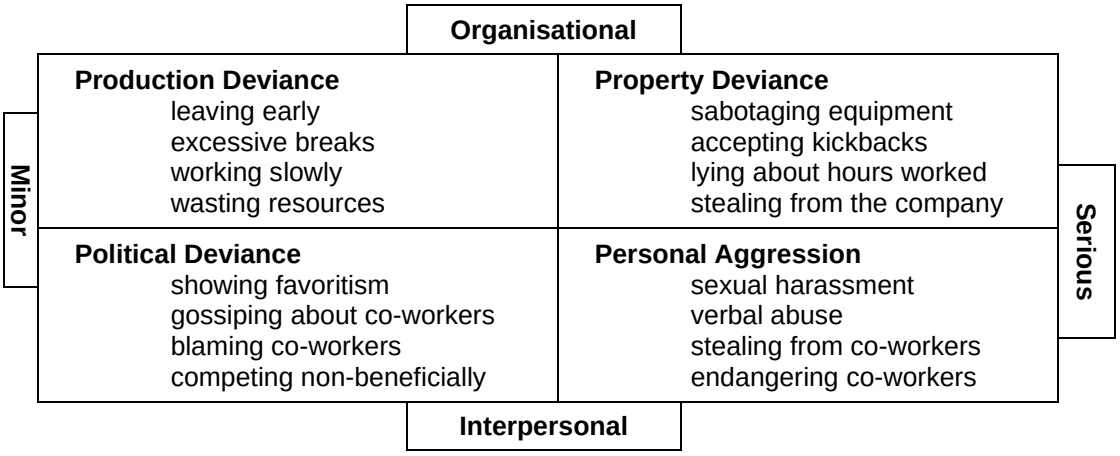
II. Answer one question from each unit. **3 × 8 Marks = 24 Marks**

UNIT-IV

1.	In 2013, computer expert and former CIA systems administrator, Edward Snowden released confidential government documents to the press about the existence of government surveillance programmes. According to many legal experts, and the USA government, his actions violated the Espionage Act of 1917 (USA), which identified the leak of state secrets as an act of treason. Despite the fact that he broke the law, Snowden argued that he had a moral obligation to act. He gave a justification for his "whistleblowing" by stating that he had a duty "*to inform the public as to that which is done in their name and that which is done against them.*" According to Snowden, the government's violation of privacy had to be exposed regardless of legality. On a radio programme moderated by Professors of Philosophy, John Perry and Kenneth Taylor, Snowden addressed the dilemmas in whistleblowing and his thoughts on his situation. Snowden was asked if he was "reluctant to break the law" or if he considered himself a hero or a traitor. Snowden said he was motivated more by "self-interest" than altruism (selfless concern for others' well-being), but he thought it'd improve societal wellbeing by eventually dismantling the NSA's metadata collection programmes, adding that he felt there would be moral obligations to act when the law no longer reflected the morality of the society it governed. US Attorney General Eric Holder stated Snowden broke the law and caused harm to national security. New York Times editors wrote that "he has done the country a great service" though "he may have committed a crime". Ed Morrissey wrote his opinion in the same paper that there were legal channels Snowden could have chosen but he did not and thus he is a criminal. (Source: https://ethicsunwrapped.utexas.edu/case-study/edward-snowden-traitor-hero) Present your argument in support or opposing Edward Snowden. Use suitable ethical theories in favour of your argument on whistleblowing.	CO-3	BL-5

(OR)

2. CO-2 BL-4



What do you understand from the above list of workplace deviances? Explain why serious crimes are serious enough for an organisation to care about. How can moral character and moral autonomy can help you avoid such deviances as above. Do you agree with the deviances and the classification into these four categories around the box? Present a critical reflection of the same and suggest improvements or changes with due justifications.

UNIT-V

3. Define safety, risk, and hazard. Why is it an engineer's job to analyse risks vs. benefits. How does costs vs. benefits relate to risk vs. benefits analysis? Illustrate graphically and/or with examples. CO-3 BL-3

(OR)

4. Present the case study of RMS Titanic from an ethical perspective. CO-4 BL-2

UNIT-VI

5. After the recent acquisition of Twitter, its CEO Elon Musk (as on date) is now banning promotions about other social media apps on Twitter. How right or wrong is it with respect to free speech as his motive? Do you think free speech is an essential ethical and moral commodity for the society? Do you think that idea of free speech insists that one must allow the voices of competitors also on one's platform? You may refer to ethical leadership aspects and/or ethical mistakes of CEOs. CO-4 BL-4

(OR)

6. The following question is an excerpt from the book "The Code Breaker" by Walter Isaacson. CO-2 BL-4

….. Our newfound ability to make edits to our genes raises some fascinating questions. Should we edit our species to make us less susceptible to deadly viruses? What a wonderful boon that would be! Right? Should we use gene editing to eliminate dreaded disorders, such as Huntington's, sickle-cell anemia, and cystic fibrosis? That sounds good, too. And what about deafness or blindness? Or being short? Or depressed? Hmmm... How should we think about that? A few decades from now, if it becomes possible and safe, should we allow parents to enhance the IQ and muscles of their kids? Should we let them decide eye color? Skin color? Height? Whoa! Let's pause for a moment before we slide all of the way down this slippery slope. What might that do to the diversity of our societies? If we are no longer subject to a random natural lottery when it comes to our endowments, will it weaken our feelings of empathy and acceptance? If these offerings at the genetic supermarket aren't free (and they won't be), will that greatly increase inequality and indeed encode it permanently in the human race?

As an engineering professional, what is your view on this? Present at least one theory in support and one theory that opposes gene editing.